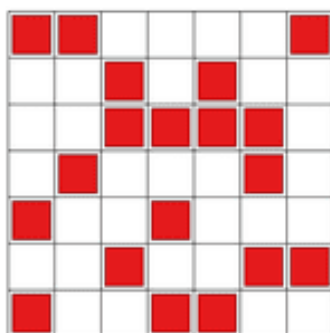


Laneways

2024, @UanarchyK, <https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/3243085>

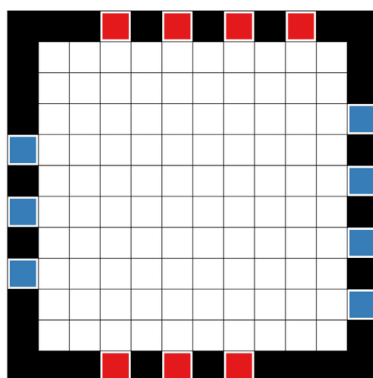
[author's words] Laneways is a "maintain connection" game for two players, playable on pen & paper or a square grid board. One player plays as the North-South sides of the board and the other as East-West.

A "path" is a sequence of unique, orthogonally adjacent squares connecting a player's two sides of the board. Players take turns blocking off one square on the board, this is now an impassible wall. There must always be at least one possible path for both players; if ever a square is blocked off that violates this, the player who made that move immediately loses. Otherwise, the game ends when both players pass. Count the shortest possible path between each players' sides, whichever player has the *longest* path, wins.



N-S has beaten E-W by 15 to 10

I still don't know if it's needed because I haven't seen many draws yet, but you can guarantee a "decisive, finite" game if you change the connections to something like this:



where you must maintain connection between at least one red square on each side, likewise blue.

A setup like this guarantees that there will always be one winner, because N-S will always have an even length path, while E-W will always have an odd parity length path.